

BizOn – Statement of direction for regional impact

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01 Strategic positioning

BizOn is a regional development initiative through entrepreneurship education, not merely an educational technology (EdTech) platform. Its value is examined along an evidence-based results chain: from the simulation experience, to decision-making capability, to entrepreneurial action and long-term contribution to the region.

Core premise:

The Mekong Delta does not lack talent; it still lacks the environment and opportunities for that talent to flourish, especially through creating and growing enterprises. BizOn helps close this gap through education built on experience and data.



Mekong Delta

02 Official vision – Option 1



A Mekong Delta where young people do not have to leave home to build a livelihood. They start enterprises on their own soil, create opportunities for regional talent, and bring Vietnamese products to the world.

Throughout: connecting opportunities to build a livelihood in the region with international competitiveness; consistent with Brand Passport, Durian Passport and the motto “From Vietnam to the world”. The vision does not mean that young people are required to stay in their home region.

03 Theoretical basis and results pathway

BizOn applies two complementary logics of entrepreneurial decision-making (Sarasvathy, 2001), set in an experiential-learning environment (Kolb, 1984) that builds self-efficacy for action (Bandura, 1977). The focus is not only the intention to start a business, but the quality of decisions and the ability to take practical next steps.

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Causation

goal-driven planning

GUIDING QUESTION

Which goal must be reached? How should the market be analysed, and how should forecasting and resource allocation be done?

USE IN THE SIMULATION

Choosing target markets, costing and break-even, revenue forecasting, drafting a business plan.

Effectuation

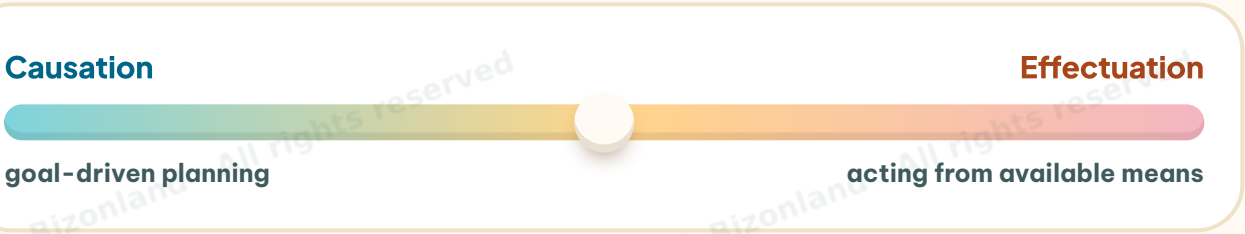
acting from available means

GUIDING QUESTION

Who am I, what do I know, whom do I know? What can I test with an acceptable loss?

USE IN THE SIMULATION

Starting from current resources, finding partners, testing with customers, adjusting course based on feedback and uncertain situations.



The two logics are not mutually exclusive: learners choose and combine them according to the goal, resources and degree of uncertainty in each situation. McMullen and Shepherd (2006) suggest observing action decisions under uncertainty; Gollwitzer (1999) stresses turning goals into concrete action plans.

A four-link pathway: from experience to regional contribution

1. Experience – Learners play simulation rounds and make business choices. Evidence: class logs, decision data, the four-level rubric. *Recorded directly.*

2. Capability – Better decision quality, forecasting, adaptation and assessment of consequences. Pre-post measures and rubric scoring; comparison groups preferred. *Change can be assessed; an appropriate design is needed to determine BizOn's influence.*

3. Decision and action – Learners decide, with justification, to pursue, adjust or pause a business opportunity, and take a validation step (customer interviews, price tests, a product prototype/MVP or partner outreach). *Verified through behaviour; not equated with registering a business.*

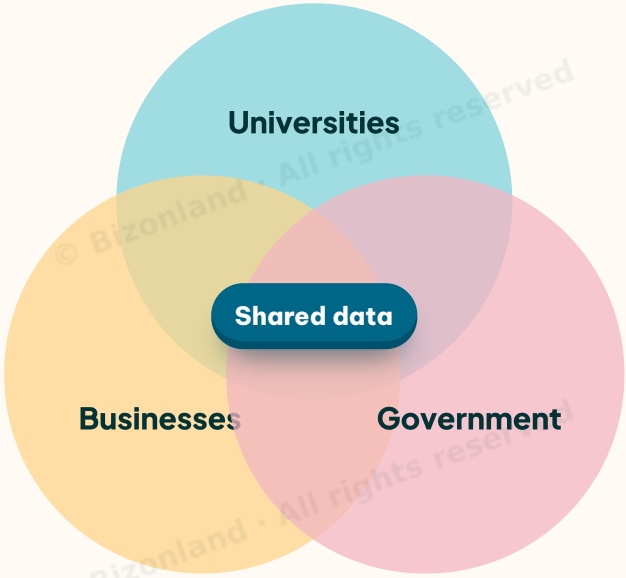
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4. Regional contribution – Job opportunities, new enterprises, production–business linkages and the ability to build a livelihood in the Mekong Delta; tracked after 12–24 months. *We only conclude that BizOn contributes, never that it is the sole cause.*

Evidence principle: "measurable" does not mean "caused by BizOn". For long-term results, we use "BizOn contributes to…" and examine other influencing factors, following the contribution-analysis approach of Mayne (2012).

04 Mission

BizOn fosters the capacity to choose and act entrepreneurially through simulation-based education, while creating a shared data foundation for "Three-party" collaboration (universities – businesses – government).



"Three-party" collaboration

BizOn aims to bring business decision-making experiences to classrooms across the Mekong Delta through explainable simulations grounded in the region's products, markets, and institutions. Learners evaluate opportunities, make entrepreneurial decisions, and take initial steps toward venture creation; instructors assess decision quality and observable actions using data; and universities, businesses, and government agencies share evidence to coordinate action.

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Implications for implementation

CONTENT	STRATEGIC IMPLICATION
Reach across Mekong Delta classrooms	Expand coverage step by step, tracking the number of institutions, courses and learners.
Products, markets and institutions as context	Use durian, floating markets, growing-area codes and the river economy as business cases that call for decisions.
Connecting the "Three parties"	Orientation towards Institution Pass, Research Edition and collaboration with the Department of Science and Technology, grounded in real evidence.

The mission is structured around four user groups: students, instructors, researchers, and institutions/partners.

05 Core values



The five core values are retained, with an emphasis on practice, transparency and responsibility when reporting impact.

1.

Mekong-rooted, world-facing

IN PRACTICE

Design cases from Mekong Delta business problems, connecting regional opportunity with international markets and value chains.

2.

Learner dignity & access

IN PRACTICE

Ensure access for institutions outside the centre; prioritise free use for learning, offline use and PWA technology.

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3.

Learning through consequences

IN PRACTICE

Create a safe environment to try, fail, adjust and learn to take responsibility for business decisions.

4.

Explainable by design

IN PRACTICE

Explain the logic of choices, simulation results and assessment criteria; provide aggregate data for policy dialogue where appropriate.

5.

Evidence before promotion

IN PRACTICE

Report within the scope of the evidence: direct results, assessed change and long-term contribution; never overstate impact.

Values statement: “We start from the alluvial soil, respect every learner, teach through consequences, explain every result and say only what the evidence allows.”

06 Results and contribution indicator framework to 2030



Indicators prioritise evidence of decisions and practical action; answers about intentions are not used as a substitute measure for entrepreneurial behaviour. Quantitative 2030 targets remain for the project team to agree.

Reach 2030 target: [To be agreed]

PRIORITY INDICATOR

Number of institutions, courses and classes taking part in the Mekong Delta; share of institutions outside Can Tho.

DATA SOURCE

Pilot registrations; class logs.

Capability

2030 target: [To be agreed]

PRIORITY INDICATOR

Improvement in knowledge, decision quality and the ability to apply causation/effectuation; level of CLO attainment.

DATA SOURCE

15-question pre/post-test; rubric; simulation data.

Action

2030 target: [To be agreed]

PRIORITY INDICATOR

Share of learners with a justified business decision; taking ≥1 opportunity-validation step (customers, price test, MVP, partner).

DATA SOURCE

Decision logs; product evidence; project logs.

Follow-up

2030 target: [To be agreed]

PRIORITY INDICATOR

Share of former learners running a project/venture or working in the Mekong Delta after 12 and 24 months; recording where they choose to build their livelihood.

DATA SOURCE

Follow-up survey (tracer study); former-learner network.

Ecosystem

2030 target: [To be agreed]

PRIORITY INDICATOR

Number of businesses and cooperatives co-designing scenarios; number of times BizOn data is used in policy dialogue.

DATA SOURCE

Partnership minutes; consultation documents.

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Measurement design: distinguish decisions inside the simulation from real-world action; record only actions with evidence. Prioritise comparison groups, 12–24-month follow-up surveys and consent to take part in research. The KT330H and KT301H pilots need to add forms recording decisions, opportunity-validation steps and the choice of where to build a livelihood.

07 Risks and mitigation measures

The key risk is over-interpreting BizOn's role in enterprise formation and migration decisions, which are shaped by many economic, social and institutional conditions.

RISK	MITIGATION MEASURES
Being seen as an initiative that serves only the local area	Keep the orientation of bringing Vietnamese products to the world; develop the Mekong Delta into a transferable living lab.
Confusing learning progress with real entrepreneurship; overstating effects on out-migration	Tier the evidence; verify action outside the simulation; use contribution language only for long-term impact.
Conflict of interest between the policy-expert and co-founder roles	Separate roles in communication; disclose the co-founder relationship when citing results from BizOn.
Dependence on public funding	Keep the principle "free to learn, paid to accompany" in order to protect access.

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08 Next implementation priorities

- [ ] Design cases that require learners to choose between goal-driven planning (causation) and acting from available means (effectuation).
- [ ] Finalise the decision-quality rubric, action logs and 12–24-month follow-up tools for the KT330H and KT301H pilots.
- [ ] Agree the 2030 targets; complete the “About BizOn” page, including disclosure of the AI adviser and the free/paid principle.
- [ ] Prepare a theory-of-change diagram and a body of evidence for discussions with the Department of Science and Technology, partners and funders.

09 Academic basis and related documents

- **Sarasvathy, S. D. (2001).** Causation and effectuation: Toward a theoretical shift from economic inevitability to entrepreneurial contingency. *Academy of Management Review, 26*(2), 243–263. **https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2001.4378020**
- **McMullen, J. S., & Shepherd, D. A. (2006).** Entrepreneurial action and the role of uncertainty in the theory of the entrepreneur. *Academy of Management Review, 31*(1), 132–152. **https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2006.19379628**
- **Kolb, D. A. (1984).** *Experiential learning: Experience as the source of learning and development*. Prentice Hall.
- **Bandura, A. (1977).** Self-efficacy: Toward a unifying theory of behavioral change. *Psychological Review, 84*(2), 191–215. **https://doi.org/10.1037/0033-295X.84.2.191**
- **Gollwitzer, P. M. (1999).** Implementation intentions: Strong effects of simple plans. *American Psychologist, 54*(7), 493–503. **https://doi.org/10.1037/0003-066X.54.7.493**

- **Mayne, J. (2012).** Contribution analysis: Coming of age? *Evaluation, 18*(3), 270–280. **https://doi.org/10.1177/1356389012451663**

BizOn foundation documents: Home | Classroom evidence | Academic foundation & Model Cards | EdTech solutions (Pilot)

Note: the additional theoretical frameworks serve to guide design and evaluation; BizOn's real-world effectiveness is only claimed when suitable research data are available.

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